

GENESIS BLOCK

HEIGHT: 0
03 JAN 2009 18:15:05 UTC
HASH: 00000000019d668...
GENESIS OUTPUT: 50 BTC
UNSPENDABLE

COINBASE MESSAGE

The Times 03/Jan/2009
Chancellor on brink of
second bailout for banks

BLOCK DATA EXCERPT

00000080	01 04 45 54 68 65 20 54 69 6d 65 73 20 30 33 2f	..EThe Times 03/
00000090	4a 61 6e 2f 30 30 30 39 20 43 68 61 6e 63 65 6c	Jan/2009 Chancel
000000a0	6c 6f 72 20 6f 6e 20 62 72 69 6e 6b 20 6f 66 20	lor on brink of
000000b0	73 65 63 6f 6e 64 20 62 61 69 6c 6f 75 74 20 66	second bailout f
000000c0	6f 72 20 62 61 6e 6b 73 ff ff ff ff 01 00 f2 05	or banks.....



GENESIS BLOCK

006 / 03 JAN 2009 / SATOSHI NAKAMOTO / MYTHIC

SECOND BAILOUT FOR BANKS.

A hooded figure sits before a wall of light. Rain streaks the window, a newspaper lies open beside the keyboard, and a familiar whitepaper rests on the desk. The room is imagined. The data on the screen comes from Bitcoin's first block.

On 3 January 2009, Satoshi Nakamoto created the Genesis block: block zero, the starting point of Bitcoin's chain. Its recorded timestamp is 18:15:05 UTC. With no earlier block to point to, it establishes the beginning of the history that later blocks would extend. The proposal introduced in the whitepaper now had its first block.

Inside its coinbase transaction, Satoshi placed a newspaper reference: The Times 03/Jan/2009 Chancellor on brink of second bailout for banks. A headline about rescuing banks became part of the new system's opening record. It anchors that record to the news of the day; reading it as a political statement is an interpretation, rather than an explanation supplied by the block itself.

The block contains a 50 BTC output that cannot be spent. On the monitor, orange characters reveal the newspaper message inside the raw data, while the rest remains blue. The whitepaper beside the keyboard links this scene to card 005: the published idea followed by a concrete beginning. The developer's face stays hidden, leaving the person behind the name unresolved.

HIDDEN IN THE ART

01 THE NEWSPAPER

The Times date and headline echo the text embedded in the first block. The physical paper and its layout are an artistic interpretation.

02 ORANGE BYTES

The highlighted hexadecimal values encode the 69 characters of the newspaper message. The five rows are a checked excerpt of the real block; orange is our visual annotation.

03 BLOCK ZERO

Height 0, the recorded timestamp, hash prefix and unspendable 50 BTC output identify the Genesis block. The monitor is an imagined interface.

04 THE WHITEPAPER RETURNS

The sheet on the right is the intentional card 005 callback. Its placement beside the keyboard is symbolic, not a documented object in Satoshi's room.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Bitcoin Core, Genesis block definition; raw Genesis block. The block data, timestamp, output and message were checked. The person, room, weather, newspaper layout and screen design are imagined; they do not establish Satoshi's identity or location.